PRICEWATCH · COMPETITOR PRICING SNAPSHOT

For Buttondown

Personalized public-page snapshot. Not affiliated with the vendors listed. Data from live pricing URLs + documented citations.

Prepared 2 Nov 2026, Africa/Lagos (WAT) | US · ~10–50 (indie/small SaaS) | Cold-email batch 1

Why this set

Newsletter SaaS competing with Mailchimp/Kit/Beehiiv. Mailchimp Free cut + MailerLite Free cut both pressure freemium newsletter economics.

Competitors below are public SaaS peers Pricewatch already monitors — chosen as a useful comparison set for this outreach draft, not a claim about your exact competitive set.

Live pricing pulls

Mailchimp email_marketing

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https://mailchimp.com/pricing/marketing/

- **Free** — $0 (≤250 contacts / 500 sends (cut effective 17 Feb 2026))
- **Essentials** — paid (Live page promotes Essentials after Free gate)
- **Standard** — paid (Higher-volume marketing plan)
- **Premium** — paid (Top self-serve tier)

Kit (ConvertKit) email_marketing

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https://kit.com/pricing

- **Free / Creator / Creator Pro** — tiered (Creator-focused newsletter plans on kit.com/pricing)

Beehiiv email_marketing

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https://www.beehiiv.com/pricing

- **Free** — $0 (Snapshot 2 Nov 2026)
- **Lite** — $49/mo (Snapshot evidence: Lite $49)
- **Pro** — $95/mo (Snapshot evidence: Pro $95)
- **Enterprise** — custom (Contact sales)

MailerLite email_marketing

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https://www.mailerlite.com/pricing

- **Free / Growing Business / Advanced** — tiered (Free cut Jun 2026: 250 subs / 2,500 emails)

Brevo email_marketing

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https://www.brevo.com/pricing/

- **Free** — $0 (Entry freemium email/SMS)
- **Starter / Business** — paid (Usage-based contact pricing on live page)

Documented moves relevant to this set

Mailchimp:

Mailchimp’s Free marketing plan tightened to 250 contacts and 500 monthly sends, effective 17 Feb 2026 after a mid-January support/community heads-up. Live pricing page now leans hard on “Under 250 contacts? It’s free.” — a classic freemium gate raise that pushes early-stage senders onto Essentials/Standard sooner.

Impact: High for bootstrapped newsletters and side projects still on Free. Competitor battlecards should refresh Brevo/MailerLite/Kit Free comparisons this week.

Citations

- **Mailchimp** — Free plan reduced to 250 contacts and 500 monthly email sends (down from higher prior Free limits). (effective 2026-02-17). Sources: https://www.reddit.com/r/MailChimp/comments/ (MailchimpSupport reply ~2026-01-13 describing Free plan cut); Inbox Tally / industry roundups referencing the Feb 17 2026 Free-tier change
- **MailerLite** — Free plan cut: active subscribers 500→250 and monthly emails 12,000→2,500 (help-center update dated 2026-06-16). (effective 2026-06-16). Sources: https://happyvalley.dev/price-changes (verified tracker citing MailerLite help center Free-plan update 16 Jun 2026); https://www.mailerlite.com/pricing

Pricewatch: https://emressp.github.io/pricewatch/ · Waitlist: https://tally.so/r/perWg1

Hosted copy: https://emressp.github.io/pricewatch/r/buttondown/

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